



DECISION

Complaint No. : POS/CH/8622/2025/Advisor-H

Name and address of the complainant : Mrs. Maryam, R/o. Flat No.A-404, Bisma Residency, Block-13, Gulistan-e-Jauhar, Near Habib University, Karachi.

Name of the Agency Complained against : Directorate of Inspection and Registration of Private Institutions, SE&LD.

Name & Designation of Investigating Officer : Rehana Ghulam Ali Memon, Advisor (H)

Vetted by :

Subject :

COMPLAINT AGAINST MANAGEMENT OF THE NEXT SCHOOL, JOHAR CAMPUS, REGARDING ALLEGED FORCED WITHDRAWAL OF THE COMPLAINANT'S SON AND NON REFUND OF THE FOUR MONTH FEE.

COMPLAINT

Ms. Maryam submitted an online complaint on 21 October 2025 against the management of The Next School, Johar Campus. She alleged that her child, who had completed one year in pre-nursery and whose speech delay and ongoing therapies were already known to the school, was expelled for yelling in class. This decision was taken after she had paid the four-month fee from June 2025 to September 2025. The school issued a cheque of Rs. 15,400/- for one month's fee, which she returned while demanding a full refund for all four months. As the school continued to delay payment, she requested the Ombudsman Sindh to intervene.

PROCEEDINGS

2. The complaint was admitted on 30.10.2025 under Section 10 of the Establishment of Office of the Ombudsman for the Province of Sindh Act, 1991 (amended up to date), by condoning delay under Section 10(3) of the Act, subject to submission of detailed complaint, copies of relevant documents, CNIC and Affidavit on Form 'A'.

3. While the case was under investigation, the child's mother contacted this office to withdraw her complaint, stating that the school had refunded the full four-month fee. She later confirmed this via email and expressed that her overall experience with The Next School, Johar Campus, was distressing. She reported that despite paying a substantial fee, the teachers were untrained, ill-behaved, and that corporal punishment created an unsafe environment even for normal children. She further informed that the teacher informed that the school does not follow an inclusive approach and that its teachers are not equipped to support her child. She emphasized the need for proper teacher training and empathy.

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FINDINGS

4. I have examined the case and found that:

- i. The teacher's conduct compelled the complainant to remove her son from the school.
- ii. The conduct of the teachers towards the normal children was reportedly inappropriate, hence they were victimized for corporal punishment and abuse.
- iii. The Section (9) of the Sindh Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities Act 2018 also says that all educational institutions funded or recognized by it provide inclusive education to the children with disabilities and admit them without discrimination.
- iv. The Cabinet in its meeting held on 04.12.2024 approved the joint strategy / policy for implementation of Inclusive Education (IE) in mainstream schools for mild autism and slow learners children. The strategy is also applicable to private schools and action will be taken against any private school that fails to comply hence school's stance that it is not inclusive dispute charging a high fee is not justified. A thorough inquiry be carried out by the Directorate of Inspection and Regulation of Private Institutions, SE&LD to determine whether the school has psychological assessment facilities for new mild autism & slow learners children and trained teachers and then fix responsibility and take action against the school as well as teacher responsible for her ill behaviour with the complainant's son as well as other normal students.

DECISION

5. In view of the above and in exercise of powers vested in me under Section-11 of Establishment of Office of the Ombudsman for the Province of Sindh Act, 1991 (amended upto date), I hereby direct as under:

- a) The Director General, Directorate General of Inspection and Regulation of Private Institutions, SE&LD, should conduct an inquiry to determine whether the school has psychological assessment facilities for new mild autism & slow learners children and trained teachers and then fix responsibility and take action against the school as well as teacher responsible for ill behaviour with the complainant's son as well as other normal students as per "The Sindh Private Educational Institution (Regulation & Control) Ordinance 2001 (Amended) Act-2003 and rules frame vide Notification No.SO(ACD-II)9-6/2005 dated 20.09.2005" as well as Prohibition of Corporal Punishment Act, 2016 and submit report to the undersigned inside 30 days.

6. The complaint is disposed of as redressed.

Given under my hand and seal of office.



Sd /-

Muhammad Sohail Rajput
Sitara-e-Imtiaz. PAS
Ombudsman Sindh

Karachi, dated 28th November, 2025